read people's lips:

'Five-one. Against Germany. In Germany. This is unbelievable.'

There were still twenty minutes left. Twenty minutes in soccer heaven. It was strange: I was involved in the build-up to the fifth goal and I had my work to do during the game; but I wasn't as much in the thick of the decisive incidents as I sometimes am playing for England. I was playing but it felt like I had the luxury of watching at the same time. I was part of it but I was admiring what these lads alongside me were doing as well. All we needed was to keep the ball. Which was what we did, getting the Germans more and more frustrated. We're not a team to showboat: our players aren't the kind to rub anybody's nose in it with little flicks and tricks. But we kept passing to each other and, as long as we were doing that, they couldn't get a touch. And it wasn't just playing out time, either. We felt like we wanted to beat Germany 10–1, never mind five.

Right after he blew the final whistle, the referee, Pierluigi Collina, came up and asked for my shirt. He must have known he'd just been part of some history being made. I think he's the best referee around, so I was happy enough. There weren't many Germans in the mood for swapping shirts, after all. I think Collina was quite pleased when I asked for his in return. All I wanted to do then was get across to the England supporters. Thousands of them had come out to Munich and the second half had sounded like we were playing at home. The noise was fantastic. I've always said that England fans are the best in the world. Put the tiny percentage of idiots to one side: our fans travel everywhere with us and give us amazing support. I'm sure every England supporter inside the Olympic Stadium could have told you stories about horrible trips to the middle of nowhere in the past and the disappointment of poor England performances. Every one of them knew how it felt to lose to rivals like Germany and Argentina. Those supporters deserved 5–1 at the Olympic Stadium as much as we did. I'm sure, as it was for the players, that night was one of the best of their lives.

Back inside I discovered I could hardly speak. My throat felt like I'd been forced to smoke twenty cigars, one after the other, over the past couple of hours. I knew I'd talked and shouted a lot during the game. Had I joined in with some of the England singing in the second half too? There was a wonderful atmosphere in that dressing room: we were so proud and so happy but we'd done all our jumping around out on the field. Now there was calm. Some players were getting massages, others were steaming in the showers and the rest, like me, were sitting in their places, slowly taking off uniform,